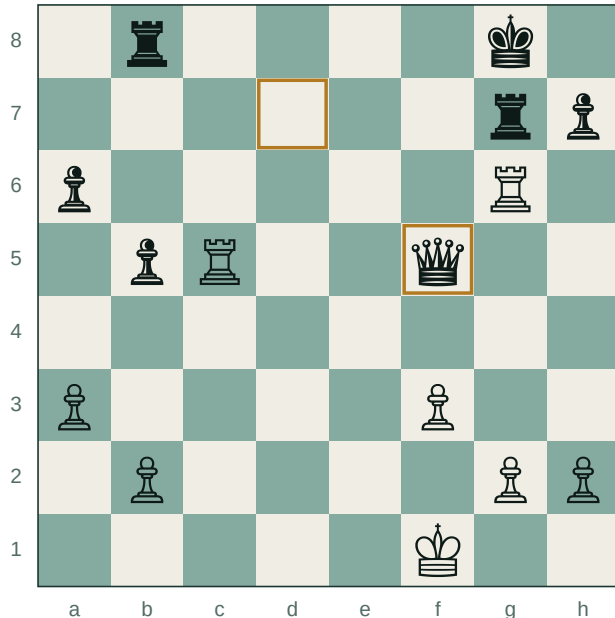


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 38

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qxf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Rxg7+ Kxg7 39. Rxf5

38.Rxg7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on g7. Recorded reply: **38...Kxg7**.

39.Rxf5 The rook captures the queen on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -7 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: rook on g7.